

Chidi Onyema

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Profile

A skilled and experienced Full Stack Software Engineer with expertise in full-stack development, DevOps, cloud computing, and open-source technologies. Proficient in modern web frontend and backend frameworks, containerisation, automation, machine learning, cloud infrastructure, high availability, and distributed computing, with a focus on building scalable, secure systems and delivering high-quality solutions.

Core Skills

- Programming Languages: C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Java
- Frameworks & Libraries: .NET Core, Node.js, Django, FastAPI, React.js, Next.js, Vue.js, Angular, Web Development: Building scalable, responsive web applications using modern frontend frameworks
- DevOps & Infrastructure:
 - Containerisation: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose
 - Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, ECS, Lambda, S3, RDS), Azure services
 - Infrastructure as Code (IaC): Terraform, CloudFormation, ARM templates
 - Networking & Security: Network security groups, load balancers, VPCs, DNS management, SSL/TLS
 - Linux & Open Source: Linux system administration, shell scripting, Nginx, Consul, Vault
- CI/CD Pipelines: Azure DevOps, TeamCity, Octopus, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD
- Automation Scripting: Bash, Python, PowerShell/
- Messaging Systems: RabbitMQ, AWS SQS/SNS, Azure Service Bus
- Security & Authentication: Identity Server, OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, HashiCorp Vault
- Databases: SQL Server, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Cosmos DB, DynamoDB
- Machine Learning: Developing models for predictive analytics, clustering algorithms, data analysis
- Agile Methodologies: Scrum, Kanban, sprint planning, backlog management
- Collaboration: Effective communication with stakeholders, technical leadership

Employment History

Founder & Engineer

glustack.com

Founder and Full Stack Engineer

June 2024 – Present

- Founded glustack.com, a full-stack technology platform focused on building modular, cloud-native tooling for modern web and mobile application development.
- Designed and implemented a scalable architecture using NextJs for frontend delivery, .NET micro-services for the backend, PostgreSQL for persistent data storage, docker tooling for containerisation and Vault for secure secret management.

Senior Full Stack Engineer, OSL Technologies

June 2024 – Present

- Design and implementation of intelligent security systems, counter-drone and situational intelligence applications, enhancing security at critical infrastructures like airports, sports events, and commercial sites.
- Developed robust and scalable backend systems for real-time data processing and analysis, leveraging technologies such as .NetCore, Java, WebSockets, RabbitMQ, and MQTT for efficient communication between system components.
- Deployed and managed micro services using Docker and container orchestration tools in a Linux environment.
- Prototyped machine learning models for threat detection and predictive analytics, contributing to the proactive identification and mitigation of security risks.
- Utilised gRPC and REST APIs for seamless integration with external security systems and data sources.
- Proficient in Bash scripting for automating tasks and managing system configurations.
- Experienced in working with real-time data streaming technologies to ensure timely and accurate situational awareness.
- Actively participated in agile ceremonies, utilising daily stand-ups to discuss security concerns, potential threats, and mitigation strategies, and focusing on improving security processes and addressing vulnerabilities during sprint retrospectives.
- Collaborated in meticulous code reviews, paying close attention to code that handles sensitive data, user authentication, and access control to ensure robust security.
- Collaborated with QA to develop comprehensive security test plans, including penetration testing and vulnerability assessments, to ensure the resilience of security systems.

Technical Lead, HM Courts & Tribunals Service (via Solirius Consultancy)

March 2023 – February 2024

- Played a multifaceted role encompassing architecture, Software Development, DevOps, cloud migration, and production support, driving significant improvements in system scalability, reliability, and security.
- Developed and maintained user-centric digital services for the UK government, adhering to Government Digital Service (GDS) standards and ensuring accessibility and inclusivity for all users.
- Contributed to high-profile projects, including the online plea service (<https://www.gov.uk/make-a-plea>) and the Gender Recognition Certificate application process (<https://www.gov.uk/apply-gender-recognition-certificate>).
- Implemented robust CI/CD pipelines using Terraform, Helm, and Kubernetes, integrating security best practices throughout the software delivery lifecycle.
- Spearheaded infrastructure modernisation and cloud migration initiatives, leveraging a deep understanding of cloud platforms (AWS, Azure) and best practices to optimise and cost- efficiency for a complex ecosystem of micro-services written in Java, Node.js, Python, Ruby, .NET, and other languages.
- Championed DevOps principles and practices, collaborating with cross-functional teams to streamline deployment processes, automate infrastructure management, and foster a culture of continuous improvement.
- Provided critical production support, troubleshooting and resolving incidents to ensure high availability and optimal performance of critical systems.
- Mentored and guided junior engineers on cloud technologies, DevOps practices, and secure coding principles.
- Collaborated closely with development teams, security engineers, and operations personnel to ensure seamless integration of DevOps practices and security considerations throughout the software development lifecycle.
- Actively participated in agile ceremonies, providing technical guidance and advocating for infrastructure and security considerations during sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and retrospectives.

Senior .NET Developer, Flagstone

October 2022 – March 2023

- Key role in the development of a cutting-edge cash deposit platform focused on optimising interest rates for users, utilising .NET Core, EF Core, C#, Azure, and SQL to build a robust and scalable solution.
- Leveraged advanced software engineering principles, employing domain-driven design (DDD) and CQRS patterns with the Brighter messaging framework to create a highly maintainable and extensible application architecture.
- Contributed to significant improvements in the CI/CD pipeline, optimising build processes and reducing build times to accelerate feature delivery and enhance team productivity.
- Enhanced code quality through the implementation of automated testing strategies and participation in rigorous code reviews, ensuring the delivery of high-quality, reliable software.
- Collaborated effectively with a team of developers, testers, and product owners in an agile environment to deliver a successful product that met user needs and business objectives.

Senior Full Stack Engineer, Omnio

February 2022 – May 2022

- Contributed to the development of a cloud-based Banking-as-a-Service (BaaS) platform, building key features using Vue.js for the frontend and .NET Core for the backend.
- Improved platform reliability and client engagement by developing robust backend services that ensured high availability, performance, and security for critical banking operations.
- Played a crucial role in building core banking functionalities, including user onboarding, KYC processes, and account management features, using C#, .NET, Vue.js, and Azure cloud services.
- Collaborated closely with designers, product managers, and other engineers in an agile environment to deliver high-quality solutions that met user needs and business requirements.
- Contributed to the development of a scalable and secure platform that enabled clients to seamlessly integrate banking services into their own applications.

Full Stack/Platform Engineer, StepStone UK

July 2020 – March 2021

- Key Technologies: AWS, .NET, Java, Node.js, Python, Terraform, Kubernetes, Helm, Bamboo, Octopus Deploy, Nginx, Python, Ruby, Docker
- Platform engineer in a cloud platform transformation project using AWS services, Docker
- A multifaceted role encompassing architecture, DevOps, cloud migration, and production support, driving significant improvements in system scalability, reliability, and security.
- Developed and implemented an enterprise-wide secrets management solution using AWS Key Management Service (KMS), ensuring secure storage and access control for sensitive credentials and API keys.
- Designed and built a self-service provisioning portal for cloud infrastructure, enabling developers to rapidly deploy and manage resources in a secure and compliant manner.
- Created standardised project templates and automated workflows to provide a seamless developer experience for new projects, reducing onboarding time and improving developer productivity.

Lead .NET Software Engineer, Philip Morris International

April 2019 – September 2020

- Developed a robust, scalable, and highly available micro-services cloud platform for commercial REST APIs using .NET Core and Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS). This involved designing and implementing micro-services architecture, containerisation, and orchestration strategies to ensure optimal performance, resilience, and resource utilisation.
- Automated infrastructure management and deployment processes with Terraform, Helm, and Azure DevOps, significantly reducing deployment time and minimising errors.
- Provisioning and configuring cloud resources, managing Kubernetes deployments, and automating CI/CD pipelines.
- Streamlined CI/CD pipelines for seamless integration and deployment across multiple environments (development, testing, staging, production), enabling rapid iteration and delivery of new features and updates.
- Implemented zero-downtime deployment strategies, such as blue/green deployments or canary releases, to ensure seamless application updates and minimise disruption to users.
- Implemented container orchestration strategies leveraging AKS, optimising resource utilisation, simplifying micro-service management, and ensuring high availability and scalability of the platform.

- Enhanced platform performance and reliability with effective use of Azure monitoring tools, auto-scaling, and efficient load balancing. This involved setting up monitoring dashboards, configuring auto-scaling rules, and implementing load balancing solutions to handle varying traffic loads and ensure optimal performance.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including developers, testers, and security engineers, to ensure seamless integration of DevOps practices and security considerations throughout the software development lifecycle.
- Actively participated in agile ceremonies, providing technical guidance and advocating for infrastructure and security considerations during sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and retrospectives.

Software Engineer, ASOS

September 2018 – January 2019

- Modernised Asos's Digital Asset Management platform by transitioning to a micro-services architecture with .NET Core, Azure, and Docker.
- Delivered clean, maintainable, and well-documented code, adhering to best practices and industry standards.
- Enhanced platform scalability, maintainability, and performance through containerised deployments and cloud-native services.
- Implemented design patterns and coding principles to promote code quality and team productivity.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to ensure seamless integration and delivery of high- quality solutions.

Lead Developer, StepStone UK

April 2016 – August 2018

- Architected and deployed containerised micro-services on Amazon ECS enhancing SEO and leveraging Docker for efficient development and deployment pipelines.
- Developed and maintained scalable applications using .NET Core, delivering robust backend solutions for high-performance systems.
- Designed and implemented infrastructure-as-code using Terraform, enabling consistent and repeatable deployments across environments.
- Configured and optimised Nginx for reverse proxying, load balancing, and Akamai edge caching to improve application performance and user experience.
- Managed relational and NoSQL databases, including SQL Server and DynamoDB, ensuring data integrity and high availability.

- Utilised Amazon S3 for scalable storage solutions and integrated it with applications for efficient data handling.
- Designed and deployed secure, high-availability architectures in AWS, ensuring seamless application performance and scalability.
- Optimised search engine performance through enhanced SEO strategies and integration with backend systems.

Senior Developer, Tesco PLC

April 2015 – April 2016

- Contributed to the development of an IaaS/private cloud platform, significantly reducing infrastructure provisioning times.
- Developed and maintained scalable backend services using .NET and dynamic front-end applications with Angular.
- Designed and managed Citrix Xen and VMware vSphere pools, optimising resource allocation and enhancing scalability.
- Automated virtual machine lifecycle processes, improving operational efficiency and reducing manual intervention.
- Ensured clean, maintainable code and implemented best practices for cloud-based infrastructure and application development.

Contract Software Engineer, BBC

March 2013 – June 2014

- Designed and implemented an advanced automation system for media processing workflows using .NET Framework, C#, and Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) principles.
- Streamlined operational efficiency by automating repetitive tasks, reducing manual intervention, and enabling faster content delivery for key broadcasting channels.
- Developed scalable and maintainable components for the system, adhering to best practices in software architecture and design patterns.
- Enhanced system performance by optimising database queries and integrating APIs for seamless communication with internal tools and third-party systems.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including editors and technical staff, to ensure the system met business needs and aligned with operational workflows.
- Delivered a robust, secure solution that improved reliability, reduced costs, and supported the BBC's commitment to innovation in media delivery.

Education

Imperial College Business School (2024 to 2024) - Professional Certificate in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

Queen Mary University of London (2002 to 2005) - BSc (Hons) in Computer Science